Independent observers felt that instead of strengthening the company, Mistry kept his sights towards the rear and circumscribed himself during his four years as the head of the group. In the process, he trapped himself into what *The Economist* termed a period of 'paralysis-by-analysis'. Whatever attempts Mistry made at consolidating the foreign acquisitions and turning them around were perceived to be feckless. Ratan thought that Mistry should have focused on building on the gains of the foreign acquisitions instead of mining for reasons to sell the notion that the Corus acquisition was an unsound strategic decision.

Mistry's criticisms were not confined to Ratan alone. He made strong allegations against several of the group veterans. He targeted Soonawala, seen as among the closest to Ratan, accusing the latter of interfering in the functioning of Tata Sons on Ratan's behalf. Soonawala dismisses the allegations as baseless. Referring to the allegations made by Mistry that he had interfered with the Welspun acquisition, he says that when Ratan and he came to know about the transaction, it was already a 'done deal'. To say that 'we came in the way, stopped it or delayed it is totally incorrect', he asserts.

Mistry's refrain was that under his predecessor, the group had stumbled from one bad business decision to another. Ratan, on the other hand, was perturbed that Mistry was spending little effort on consolidating the large acquisitions that had been made in the last few years of his chairmanship of Tata Sons. As Nohria comments, Mistry was 'blaming the problems that he had inherited in the past rather than saying that he also inherited assets from the past'.

With the continued criticism of Ratan and little effort being expended on consolidating foreign acquisitions, the chemistry between Mistry and Ratan soured. Nohria adds that Mistry, 'rather than move forward, put more and more blame on the past … but it's not like this was a person who didn't have goodness in him and some strengths but that's not adequate to run a company like this'.

The group's performance also dipped. The Tata companies under Mistry were 'moving sideways'. He was 'not destroying the company', but it 'would have started to decline because no forward action was being taken', Nohria comments. In the light of all these factors, a hard decision had to be made. And as Nohria says, in 'my honest opinion' this was a person who was 'incapable of being decisive'.